

Letsema

Many hands, one pathway to work.

Presented by Gloria Mukendi | Hackathon 2026 Submission

01. THE PROBLEM

Young South Africans cannot turn skills into income

47.4%

Youth Unemployment

Official rate for ages 15–34 (Stats SA, Q2 2026).

5.0m

Unemployed Youth

264,000 more than in Q1 2026.

60.9%

Ages 15–24 Rate

Severe job scarcity in early adult brackets (Q1 2026).

45.6%

NEET Rate

Not in employment, education, or training (Q1 2026).

02. HUMAN CONTEXT

Behind the statistics: Meet Sphesihle



The Entry-Level Paradox

Meet Sphesihle, who finished her data qualification in 2021. Despite continuous job hunting, she remains unemployed. She wants financial independence, but standard CVs fail to prove her practical competence, and entry-level jobs demand experience she has had no opportunity to build.

The Systemic Failure

Traditional education certifies theory, but employers hire for execution. Without verified project portfolios and transparent AI-graded challenges, qualified youth remain stuck in the unemployment queue.

03. THE SOLUTION

Letsema

Letsema is rooted in the Sesotho and Setswana tradition of communal work where neighbors pitch in together to finish a big job no one could do alone. We unite companies, NGOs, and youth into a self-sustaining ecosystem of skill acquisition, community impact, and verified career placement.

LETSEMA
COLLABORATIVE
WORK TOGETHER | GROW TOGETHER

Gamified Skills

Interactive arcade games and practical challenges build foundational capability.

Real NGO Work

Nonprofit tasks providing authentic paid experience and community service.

Direct Placement

Verified portfolios placed directly into corporate recruitment pipelines.

04. USER ECOSYSTEM

Three key users driving the loop of value

1. Individuals

Students and novices learn through practical challenges, earn points via AI grading, pitch for NGO projects, and build a verified portfolio.

2. NGOs

Nonprofits seeking affordable service alternatives post projects with budgets they can afford, choose pitches, and pay upon completion.

3. Companies

Employers seeking interns and juniors view shared profiles instantly or subscribe to weekly runner-up lists ranked by field and location.

05. MECHANISM

How It Works: Step-by-Step

01

Practice & Build

Games reinforce skills while practical challenges build real-world capability.

02

AI Evaluation

AI marks built work against strict rubrics, giving instant feedback and points.

03

Pitch & Deliver

Points unlock NGO missions; NGOs review delivery and leave ratings.

04

Discovery

Opt-in portfolio links and weekly ranked lists connect talent to employers.

06. VALUE PROPOSITION

Why It Works & Why Invest

Why It Works

Proof Over CVs: Verifiable project deliverables.

Mobile-First Design: Built for low-data mobile usage.

Mutual Incentive: Solves NGO shortages with paid experience.

Automated Guardrails: AI rubrics ensure fair evaluation.

Why Invest

Massive Market: Tackles 47.4% youth unemployment.

Scalable Revenue: NGO platform fees & subscriptions.

High Social Impact: Drives economic inclusion.

Tech Ready: Built with React Native and Supabase.

07. BUSINESS MODEL

Monetization, Targets & Break-Even



Revenue Streams

Free for job seekers. NGOs pay a 10% fee on project budgets, and companies subscribe to targeted runner-up lists at R499/month per list.



6 & 12-Month Targets

Targeting 5,000 active youth, 200 NGO partners, and 50 corporate subscribers across Gauteng within the first year of pilot launch.



Break-Even Model

Achieving operational self-sustainability within 14 months driven by recurring corporate subscription fees and high transaction volume.

08. ARCHITECTURE & SECURITY

Engineering Status & Security Controls

Core Tech Stack

Built as an Expo / React Native mobile app with Supabase authentication and database storage, plus server-side Edge Functions for AI-assisted assessment.

Security & Testing

Database Row-Level Security (RLS) and permission-checked actions. Assessment scores validated server-side. Automated tests cover assessment evidence and privacy.

Conclusion

Letsema connects practice to opportunity: individuals complete challenges, understand rubric feedback, pitch for community work, and share portfolios they control.

Building The Future Together